

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the questions remain the same for the 50th General Service Conference Evaluation Form.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a letter and form to be sent out annually in early September to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topic.

ARCHIVES

- The committee reviewed the proposed draft of a Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Archives Committee and accepted it with suggested amendments.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and took no action. It was the sense of the committee that, as service material, the Kit and Workbook could be updated as often as shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Workbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.
- The committee reviewed the text added to six C.P.C. pamphlets by the 1997 General Service Conference under the title "Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other Than Alcohol" and took no action because they could not reach substantial unanimity.
- The committee reviewed a drawing of a proposed new panel for the current C.P.C. Exhibit to replace the "Our Beginnings" panel and supported the spirit of the panel change.
- Following a thorough review of the C.P.C. Kit, the committee made a minor change. The committee encouraged local C.P.C. committees to utilize both the shared experience of others involved in C.P.C. work and the C.P.C. Workbook.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed a draft of a one-page informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals and agreed that, with minor editorial changes, the letter be distributed biannually to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada.
- The committee considered additions/revisions to the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and suggested that the Publications Department prepare a draft of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" for review by the 2000 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities that will include:
 - 1) New graphics that do more to depict hope
 - 2) An easier-to-read format
 - 3) "Clyde's" story
 - 4) New stories depicting A.A. members with long-term sobriety while incarcerated, in addition to all current stories.

FINANCE

- The committee unanimously recognizes that the acceptance of discounts or subsidies in the form of cash causes discomfort to some members of our Fellowship. The committee suggests that any future negotiations regarding International Convention discounts or subsidies be carried out with this in mind.
- In expectation of continuing discussion of Self-Support, the committee invites areas to share their experience in Self-Support with the committee.
- After broad discussion on Self-Support, we unanimously encourage the use of our existing communication tools, such as the video "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure." The committee noted the use of visual aids is very helpful in generating interest in service pieces and correspondence, such as the quarterly mailing, and suggests they be used.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in 2001 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a soft-cover anthology of letters selected from those published in the magazine from 1944 to the present.
- The committee liked the idea of an audio form of the monthly magazine produced by the Grapevine, and asked the Grapevine staff to determine the level of interest in the Fellowship and bring back a report to the Conference Committee on the Grapevine in the year 2000.
- The committee discussed the request to establish a committee to review and approve all articles prior to publication in the Grapevine, and determined that the current process for the selection of articles works well.
- The committee would like to encourage areas to purchase Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions and back issues for direct placement in treatment facilities and correctional facilities.
- Being mindful of the demonstrated effectiveness of La Viña and the need for it expressed by the Hispanic community, and considering its spiritual benefits and benefits as a Twelfth Step tool, the committee wishes to express strong support for its continued publication.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested that delegates get districts involved, especially the host district where a Forum is held; encourage new people to go to Forums and to submit topics of interest for presentations and workshops; distribute Forum flyers and place Forum information in area, district, central office and intergroup newsletters. Suggest that Forums have more flexibility and open scheduling of the agenda; questions on the Forum floor need more direct answers. Special Forums are working well and have brought areas and districts together. The committee looks forward to a great year ahead with four Regional and two Special Forums planned in Altoona, Pennsylvania; San Juan, Puerto Rico; Sheridan, Wyoming; Ann Arbor, Michigan; Window Rock, Arizona; and Lubbock, Texas.
- The committee suggested that area/state/provincial convention committees be lovingly requested to consider not planning conventions six weeks before or after the 2000 International Convention, since attendance at local events during this time might be adversely affected. As local committees are planning

events up to three years prior to the event, it is suggested that the committee discuss this request at least three years prior to the 2005 International Convention.

- The committee discussed proposed revisions to current Guidelines and Procedures for International Conventions Site Selection and requested that G.S.O. management and the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums prepare revised Guidelines and Procedures for International Conventions Site Selection based on experience from the 2005 site selection and that these revised Guidelines and Procedures be presented for review by the 2000 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums implement an inventory on International Conventions similar to the 1999 Regional Forums inventory and forward an Inventory Report for discussion to the 2000 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

- The committee strongly suggested that no index be included in any Fourth Edition Big Book.
- The committee discussed with appreciation the proposal for an A.A. history book and agreed that there were ample existing resources on A.A. history and that there was no compelling need to develop this project.
- Expressing substantial concerns about unity and inclusivity in the A.A. Fellowship, the committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee, through the General Service Office, distribute a questionnaire soliciting input from all Conference areas on whether there is a need for the continued development of "special interest" literature in a society that has many faces in one Fellowship.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee considered a proposal that all Secondary Conference Committees be composed of nine voting members without regard for representation from every region and agreed that it is reasonable to have nine voting members on secondary committees with an attempt to have a balanced regional representation, with the exception of the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums which should continue to be composed of eight delegates (one from each region) because of the importance of having every region represented when the committee is involved with site selection for an International Convention.
- The committee considered a proposal that all Secondary Conference Committees meet jointly with the corresponding trustees' committees and then meet separately to discuss agenda items and make recommendations reached by majority vote (if any) and saw no reason to change the current practice of meeting jointly with the corresponding trustees' committee with the



understanding that, although trustee committee members are present, only members of the Conference Committees vote on recommendations to the Conference as a whole.

- Although the committee recognized the importance of bridging the gap between treatment and correctional facilities and the A.A. group, the committee saw no need for a Conference Bridging the Gap Committee at this time. The committee expressed confidence that the trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment and Correctional Facilities will do everything possible to enhance interest in this activity at the area and district level. It was also noted that the needs of Bridging the Gap Committees are being met by the Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities assignments at G.S.O.

- The committee discussed possible future needs of the Conference in terms of combining or reassigning committee functions and agreed that this may need closer attention in the years to come.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Public Information Committee's report on the A.A. Fact File and approved all of the suggested minor editorial revisions.
- The committee discussed anonymity at the public level on the Internet and suggested that area delegates explain at the local level that "electronic media" is implicit in the last phrase of the Eleventh Tradition and that areas be encouraged to discuss anonymity at the public level of the Internet. The committee further suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review P.I. literature to add "Internet" or "electronic media" where collective experience refers to press, radio, films and TV, and requested that the trustees' P.I. Committee report back to the 2000 Conference P.I. Committee.
- The committee discussed the 1998 and current report on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity. The committee applauded the effectiveness of the A.A. Web site as an adequate and valuable public information tool in carrying the message and providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the Public Information pamphlet "Where Do I Go From Here?" be included in the contents of the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered suggestions for changes to the revised manuscript of *The A.A. Service Manual* offered by Conference members after April 1, and decided that since they came in after a deadline set for the committee's review, they should go through the committee process by being offered for the agenda of the 2000 Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee considered a proposal to add a footnote to Warranty Five, page 72, *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 1998-99 edition, stating that Alcoholics Anonymous will continue to oppose unauthorized use of its registered trademarks. The committee unanimously agreed the footnote should not be added, agreeing with the 1997 Report and Charter Committee that it was not necessary to footnote the Warranty because the right of decision in such matters rests with the A.A. World Services Board on behalf of the General Service Board, U.S. and Canada.
- The committee discussed a proposal that G.S.O. print all listed groups in its directories unless a group chooses not to be included. It was decided not to suggest the change because it was felt the present policy of requiring a phone number in directory listings agrees with a 1977 Conference Advisory Action which states, "Only full names and phone numbers that may be used for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information from any source be published. This will be clearly indicated on the group information sheet."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the condensed summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire requesting sharing on carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals. The committee suggested that a section on "Carrying the Message into Psychiatric/Mental Health Facilities or State Hospitals" be added to the Treatment Facilities Handbook.
- The committee discussed both the condensed and unedited summary of responses to the June 1998 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire requesting sharing on carrying the message into non-correctional youth facilities. The committee suggested that a section on "Carrying the Message Into Non-Correctional Youth Facilities" be added to the Treatment Facilities Handbook.
- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts. As a result of their discussions, the committee emphasized the importance of continued attention to this most valuable Twelfth-Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Treatment Facilities Handbook:
 - 1) The committee discussed the title of the 1998 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee's list of "Suggested Goals for Treatment Facilities Committees." The committee suggested that this section be retitled "Some Suggested Activities for Treatment Facilities Committees."
 - 2) The committee reviewed the revised text in the section entitled "Fellowships Similar to A.A." in the Treatment Facilities Handbook and welcomed the simplified version.
- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Handbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and took no action. The committee unanimously agreed that as service material, the Kit and Handbook may be updated as often as our shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Handbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed adding the following statement to the vacancy announcement letters for appointed committee member, Class A trustee, regional trustee, and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada:

"In seeking applicants for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

The committee was unanimous that the statement was reflective of A.A. principles but felt uncomfortable with the word "diversity." The committee suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee review the statement again to determine if any such statement is necessary, or if it could be improved, and report back to the Conference Committee on Trustees in April 2000.

- The committee reviewed the role of appointed committee members and recognized they are a great resource to trustees' committees, providing a richness of experience and expertise to the committees on which they serve. The committee felt that appointed committee members should continue to be members of A.A. and thanked currently-serving appointed committee members for their service to the Fellowship.
- The committee expressed appreciation to the chairman of the General Service Board for communicating that five of seven Class A trustees will be rotating off the board in the years 2000-2001, and understands that the chairman may feel the need to exercise his option to extend the term of one or more Class A trustees in order to maintain continuity on the board.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

Floor Action #2:

- That the 49th General Service Conference direct the trustees' Literature Committee to evaluate the Conference Literature Committee's "strong suggestion" to distribute a questionnaire soliciting input from all Conference areas on whether there is a need for the continued development of "special interest" literature in a society that has many faces in one Fellowship. In this evaluation, the trustees' Literature Committee should weigh out the benefits of such a questionnaire and determine if such a questionnaire would in fact, give us a group conscience. They should report back to the Conference Literature Committee. **(Not approved)**

Floor Action #3:

- That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., return the \$250,000 cash incentive received from the city of San Diego for the 1995 International Convention. **(Not approved)**

Floor Action #4:

- That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., refrain from accepting the \$100,000 cash incentive from the city of Minneapolis for the 2000 International Convention. **(Not approved)**

Mickey Hardesty's (Utah) area gave him a going away present of a Mickey Mouse hand puppet—to use in response to roll call and to remind him of Rule 62: Don't take yourself too seriously.